non-clinical support such as home maintenance (plumbing, electrical work, housekeeping), convenience services like chauffeurs and travel assistance, teleconsultations and even technology support for laptops and smartphones.

"The idea behind providing care services at home," says Saumyajit Roy, co-founder and CEO of Emoha Elder Care, "is to create an ecosystem that works for elders in the comfort of their own home and enables them to live an independent life." In the business for over four years now, Emoha has served 60,000 elders across 120 cities and towns. Their model involves assigning a caregiver from the local area to a senior for regular check-ins, understanding their daily needs and arranging the necessary support. Seventy-two-year-old educationist and child counsellor Rashmi Gautam turned to them this March when she experienced stomach issues and had to be hospitalised. Since both her children are abroad, she had been living alone in Ghaziabad with a full-time help, who happened to be on leave. A caregiver from Emoha assisted her with hospital check-in, admission and insurance until her daughter arrived from Singapore the next day. "They took over completely," says Gautam. "In fact, I trusted them so much that I even shared my PIN with them. I had to hand over the jewellery I was wearing, all of which they returned to me safely."

In fact, senior living players such as Antara and CovaiCare have now expanded clinical and non-clinical services to not just their residents but also to other seniors in the cities they operate in. CovaiCare, for example, launched Namma Jini, a home and health management service for elders, in Chennai this July and will introduce it in Coimbatore, Mysuru, Bengaluru and Hyderabad next year.

A SPACE OF THEIR OWN

Housing options for the elderly who want to live independently and with others like them, and the model of ownership offered

HARDIK CHHABRA



COVAICARE S3 ▼

Coimbatore

Ownership: For sale

Facilities: Housekeeping, nursing, doctor, library, security, caregiving, assisted living, activity centres, funeral services

COST

2BHK villa: Rs 65 lakh
4BHK villa: Rs 1.4 cr.

MAINTENANCE

Rs 10 per square foot (Rs 8,000–Rs 12,000) + Food (Rs 260 per day)



ANTARA ▲

Dehradun

Ownership: Lease tenure of 60 years, extended every 15 years

Facilities: Housekeeping, nursing, resident doctor, library, heated swimming pool, customised activity plans, customised diet plans, accessible infrastructure

COST

1BHK: Rs 2.41 cr. to Rs 4.11 cr.

Penthouse: Rs 16.17 cr. to Rs 17.73 cr.

MAINTENANCE

Rs 27 per square foot (Rs 47,000–Rs 75,000, plus taxes)

Beating Loneliness

"Eldercare is often viewed through the lens of disease," says Roy of Emoha. "The most basic question asked is '*aap theek ho*?' (Are you okay?). But '*theek ho*' has many dimensions." Physical health accounts for just 20 per cent of the care requirement; the rest is social, mental and psychological, he adds. A study published in medical journal *The International Journal of Geriatric Psychiatry* in 2021 found that 20.5 per cent of

With people living longer, the number of years they require support for has also gone up. Hence the rise in assisted living services